



Center of devotion

Within what was once the great city of Angkor is the temple of Angkor Wat. It is surrounded by a wall and a 656-ft- (200-m-) long, rectangular moat. The temple sits in the center of this vast complex, the largest religious monument in the world. Its five spires represent the five peaks of Mount Meru—the center of the universe in both Hindu and Buddhist beliefs.



2 The inner temple was the most sacred place in Angkor Wat.

In this image, remains of dense villages that once surrounded the temple show up in a light orange color.

Shadows of a city

New technology has allowed archaeologists to see traces of ancient structures around Angkor Wat. Laser scanners were used to create maps of canals, roads, and villages.

